

24-HOUR LLM BUILD SPRINT

# Hack Armenia

Build an LLM system that can **evaluate** evidence, **reason** under uncertainty,  
and **generalize** — for Armenia's public interest.

August 8–9, 2026 · AI9 Startup Campus · Yerevan



AI9

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# Welcome to Hack Armenia

**One weekend. One theme. A working LLM system that actually does something useful for Armenia — and evidence that it works.**



## **Build**

24 hours to go from idea to a running prototype, with mentors in the room.



## **Measure**

Show numbers. An evaluation — even a lightweight one — is what separates the top teams.



## **Pitch**

5 minutes in front of an expert jury on Sunday. Talk plus live demo.

# The sprint in numbers

**24h**

**of building**  
Sat 10:00 → Sun

**60—80**

**participants**  
one cohort

**15—20**

**teams**  
3—4 people each

**12**

**mentors**  
on-site Saturday

**7**

**jury members**  
judging Demo Day

**9**

**domains**  
Armenia's public interest

# The theme: Armenia's public interest

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**Nothing is revealed at kickoff — the theme *is* the brief. Pick a real problem that matters here, and build for it.**

## **Evaluate**

Weigh evidence and cite what it is grounded in.

## **Reason**

Work through uncertainty instead of guessing confidently.

## **Generalize**

Hold up across real cases, not just your happy path.

The domains and example projects that follow are there to guide you — bring your own idea in the same spirit.

# Nine public-interest domains

Where LLMs can be genuinely useful to Armenia. Choose one — or bring your own.



## Urban development

City ops, planning & mobility



## Public systems & policy

Filings, evidence & transparency



## Healthcare

Safe triage, admin & patient education



## Education

Tutoring, grading & Armenian-language learning



## Security

Phishing defense, secure code & threat triage



## Food & agriculture

Crop advisory, food safety & nutrition



## Environment & energy

Efficiency, hazards & resources



## Finance & fintech

Fair credit, fraud & literacy



## Emergency & disaster

Coordination, preparedness & response

# Example projects

Starting points, not requirements. Full list on the website.



## SME tax-filing copilot

Walk a small business through declarations; extract figures from receipts and pre-fill the forms.



## Guarded symptom triage

Route symptoms to the right level of care in Armenian — with hard safety rails. Not diagnosis.



## Auto-grading assistant

Grade short answers against a rubric, write feedback, and flag borderline cases for the teacher.



## Phishing & scam detector

Catch bank-impersonation SMS and fake government notices aimed at Armenian users.



## Crop advisory agent (VLM)

Diagnose plant disease from a photo and advise on treatment and timing, in Armenian.



## Response coordination agent

Turn chaotic incoming incident reports into a de-duplicated, prioritised response picture.

# Rules & tools



## Any model or API

Open or closed, local or hosted. Bring your own keys where you can.



## Open source required

Projects must be open source and fully reproducible. No closed black boxes.



## Armenian encouraged

Not required, but Armenian-language support is a real plus.



## Use real data

Anything publicly available, or data we provide before or during the event.



## Teams of 3–4

Form your team at kickoff. 15–20 teams in total.



## Build it here

Come with ideas, not with a finished codebase. The work happens during the sprint.

# The 24 hours

**Sat 10:00**

## **Kickoff & briefing**

Welcome, theme walkthrough, logistics.

**Sat 11:00**

## **Teams form & plan**

Form a team of 3–4, scope your problem and data.

**Sat 15:00–18:00**

## **Mentors on-site**

Mentors available in the room — flexible, drop in any time.

**Sat → Sun**

## **Build**

Prototype end-to-end early, then harden and evaluate.

**Sun 12:00**

## **Code freeze**

Lock the repo, prepare your talk and demo.

**Sun 13:00**

## **Demo Day**

5-minute pitches to the jury.

**After demos**

## **Awards**

The jury names the winners.



# Your mentors

On-site **Saturday 15:00–18:00** — flexible, drop in any time.



**Philipp Guevorguian**

Technical Staff · Perceptron AI



**Aram Shakhbandaryan**

Founder · Empty.ai



**Ani Vanyan**

ML Researcher · YerevaNN



**Khoren Petrosyan**

ML Researcher · YerevaNN



**Naré Gevorgyan**

CEO · AICA



**Marie Mikayelyan**

CPO · OmniShift



**Hovhannes  
Kuloghlyan**

Co-Founder · Wirestock



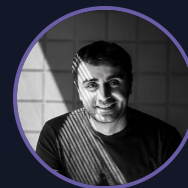
**Armen Grigoryan**

Head of TV & Digital Products ·  
Ucom



**Khachik Badeyan**

Technical Portfolio Lead · PMI  
Science Armenia



**Gevorg Minasyan**

Async



**Davit Karamyan**

NVIDIA



**Tigran Atoyan**

Founder & AI Researcher

# How to use your mentors

## **Come with a specific question**

“Is this evaluation sound?” beats “what do you think of our idea?”. Mentors are most useful once you have something concrete.

## **Show them something running**

Even a broken prototype gives a mentor more to work with than a slide.

## **Ask about scope**

The most common 24-hour failure is building too much. Mentors will help you cut.

## **Product and technical both**

Some mentors will push on your model and evaluation, others on who actually uses this and why.

Mentors are on-site Saturday 15:00–18:00. Timing is flexible — grab whoever is free.

# What you hand in



## Working demo

It has to run. A rough end-to-end demo beats a polished deck.



## Artifact

A repo with reproducible code — plus an app link if you have one.



## Evaluation

A test set, rubric, examples, or benchmark — with numbers.



## Impact note

Who uses it, and what changes if it works.

Code freeze is Sunday 12:00 — lock the repo and prepare your pitch before then.

# The pitch: 5 minutes, maximum

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**Five minutes total per team, split however you like between the talk and the demo.**



## The talk

The problem, why an LLM is the right tool, how you evaluated it, and what you found — including where it breaks.



## The demo

Show it running on a real case. Live is best; a recording is fine if the network is not.

Split it as you see fit — but at 5:00 you stop. Practise it once before you present.

# How you are judged

One rubric for every team, whatever domain you pick.

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1

## Idea quality & fit

Does it target a real Armenian public-interest problem worth solving?

2

## Evaluation & evidence

Did you actually test the system and show results — not just assert them?

3

## Model limits & safety

Do you know where the model fails, and how you mitigate it?

4

## Real-world plausibility

Could this work outside the demo — realistic data, reproducible, deployable?

# What judges look for



## **A working prototype**

Judges want to see it run, not just slides.



## **An evaluation method**

Even lightweight. “It seems to work” is not evidence.



## **Failure modes & safety**

Name where it breaks and who it could harm. Show your guardrails.



## **Realistic data**

Toy data that ignores messy reality will not convince.



## **The LLM earns its place**

If a regex or a plain form would do the job, use that instead.

# The jury

Who you present to on Sunday at 13:00.



**Gevorg Mantashyan**

First Deputy Minister · Ministry of High-Tech  
Industry



**David Zokhrabyan**

Growth · OpenAI



**Davit Arakelyan**

Chief Business Officer · Eleveight AI



**Perouz Taslakian**

AI Research Scientist / Research Lead ·  
ServiceNow AI Research



**Arik Akhverdyan**

Co-Founder & CEO · AI9



**Vazgen Hakobjanyan**

Founder & CEO · Magical Labs



**Vazgen Badalyan**

Founder · Evidenso

# The organizers

Hack Armenia is run by the Armenia LLM Summer School, AI9 and YerevaNN.



**Armen Aghajanyan**

Perceptron AI



**Aram Galstyan**

USC / Amazon



**Erik Arakelyan**

Senior Researcher · NVIDIA Armenia



**Hrant Khachatryan**

Founding Director · YerevaNN



**Perouz Taslakian**

ServiceNow AI Research



**Tatev Vardanyan**

YerevaNN



**Arik Akhverdyan**

Co-Founder & CEO · AI9





# Prizes



## 1st place

Best overall build

PRIZE BY OPENAI



## 2nd place

Runner-up

PRIZE BY OPENAI



## 3rd place

Third place

PRIZE BY OPENAI



## Special prize

An additional award chosen by **Eleveight AI**.

NOW GO BUILD

# Good luck

Ship something that runs, measure it honestly, and tell us who it helps.

Demo Day — Sunday 13:00 · [armeniallm@gmail.com](mailto:armeniallm@gmail.com)



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